

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 80

By Leatherwood

A RESOLUTION to designate May 2025 as "National Hypertension Month" and to advocate for greater access to innovative therapies.

WHEREAS, hypertension, also known as high blood pressure, affects nearly half of all adults in the United States and is a leading risk factor for various cardiovascular diseases; and

WHEREAS, hypertension often goes undetected and untreated, leading to severe health complications, including heart disease, stroke, and kidney failure, and contributing to nearly 500,000 deaths per year in the United States; and

WHEREAS, only about one in four adults in the United States have their hypertension under control; and

WHEREAS, healthcare costs in the United States associated with hypertension account for about \$131 billion per year, while individuals with hypertension are estimated to face nearly \$2,000 higher annual healthcare expenditures compared to those without hypertension; and

WHEREAS, recent advancements in medical technology have introduced U.S. Food and Drug Administration-approved renal denervation therapies as a promising treatment for resistant hypertension, offering hope to patients who do not respond adequately to conventional treatments; and

WHEREAS, renal denervation therapies have demonstrated clinical and real-world results in reducing blood pressure and improving cardiovascular outcomes; and

WHEREAS, access to innovative treatments is essential for improving public health and reducing the burden of hypertension-related complications; and

WHEREAS, a recent scientific statement from the American Heart Association suggests that "renal denervation presents a novel treatment strategy for patients with uncontrolled blood pressure"; and

WHEREAS, the month of May is recognized as National Hypertension Month to raise awareness about the importance of preventing, detecting, and managing hypertension; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we designate May 2025 as "National Hypertension Awareness Month" to promote awareness, education, and prevention of hypertension.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we encourage health providers, public health organizations, and community groups to participate in activities and initiatives highlighting the importance of hypertension management and prevention; advocate for the inclusion of renal denervation therapies in health insurance coverage plans to ensure patients with resistant hypertension can access this innovative treatment option; and support efforts to educate the public about the risks of hypertension and the benefits of early detection and treatment, including the potential role of renal denervation and other innovative therapies.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we urge the Department of Health to promote best practices for hypertension management and encourage TennCare to consider the inclusion of innovative therapies such as renal denervation in Medicaid coverage.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be transmitted to the Commissioner of the Department of Health and the Director of TennCare.